MERIDIAN MACRO

The Macro Cheat Sheet

November 2026

Ten charts. The numbers that matter right now, each with its official source and date, one takeaway and one line of context.

1 Brent crude (ICE)
2 US 10-year Treasury
3 US CPI year-over-year
4 US Dollar Index (ICE)
5 Gold (COMEX)
6 Copper (COMEX)
7 Heating oil / diesel (NYMEX)
8 S&P 500 index
9 US unemployment (BLS)
10 US Strategic Petroleum Reserve (EIA)

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Data as of 5 Nov 2026. Built from ICE, US Treasury, BLS, COMEX, NYMEX, S&P Dow Jones Indices and EIA data. Never FRED.
Charl Van Zyl, financial data analyst | meridianmacroweekly.substack.com
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1. Brent is back below $100, eight months into the war



Brent futures traded near USD 94.25 on Nov 5, down from above USD 117 at end-October (ICE Futures Europe). The slide eases fuel bills, but the price is still about USD 22 above the pre-war close near USD 72, so the war premium has not gone.

LATEST **USD 94.25** ICE Futures Europe · 2026-11-05

2. The 10-year yield has eased, but stays near 5%



The US 10-year yield closed at 4.95% on Nov 3 (US Treasury Daily Treasury Par Yield Curve Rates). It has come off the early-October peak above 5.3%, yet it still prices a tight policy path that equity relief rallies keep underestimating.

LATEST **4.95%** US Treasury · 2026-11-03

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3. US inflation cooled, then stalled above the Fed's target



Headline CPI rose 3.7% over the 12 months to September 2026 (BLS, CPI release Oct 14, 2026). That is hotter than the August print, and still well above the Fed's 2% goal, so another oil leg would land on an inflation problem that never fully left.

LATEST **3.7%** BLS · Sep 2026

4. The dollar is still a pressure valve for the rest of the world



The dollar index sits near 101.26 (ICE US Dollar Index, Nov 5 session). When US yields and war risk bid for safety, a firm dollar tightens conditions for oil importers and emerging markets even if US equities look calm.

LATEST **101.26** ICE · 2026-11-05

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5. Gold holds above $4,100 as hedges stay bid



Gold futures are around USD 4,137 an ounce (COMEX, Nov 5 session). Through 2025 and 2026 it has been the cleanest hedge for geopolitics, fiscal risk and sticky inflation, and the chart shows that bid has not faded.

LATEST **USD 4,137** COMEX · 2026-11-05

6. Copper is the industrial pulse check on China and the energy transition

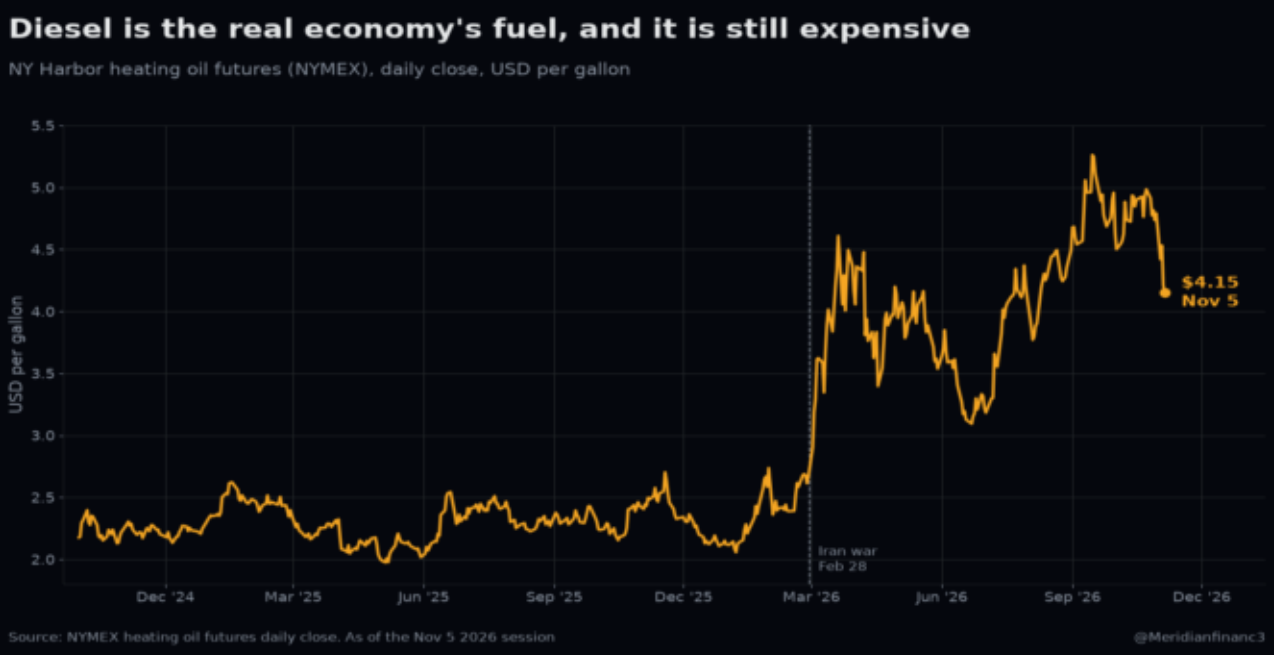


Copper is near USD 6.39 per pound (COMEX, Nov 5 session). It is still the best liquid read on China industrial demand and the grid buildout, and softness here usually shows a growth warning before equity indexes do.

LATEST **USD 6.39** COMEX · 2026-11-05

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7. Diesel is the real economy's fuel, and it is still expensive



NY Harbor heating oil is about USD 4.15 a gallon (NYMEX, Nov 5 session), the closest futures proxy for diesel. Elevated diesel prices transmit Gulf and Russian supply risk straight into freight, farming and food costs.

LATEST **USD 4.15** NYMEX · 2026-11-05

8. Equities are pricing resilience while oil and yields stay hard



The S&P 500 closed near 7,689 on Nov 4 (S&P Dow Jones Indices). Equities are pricing resilience while Brent still sits well above its pre-war level and the 10-year stays near 5%. That three-way tension rarely lasts forever.

LATEST **7,689** S&P Dow Jones Indices · 2026-11-04

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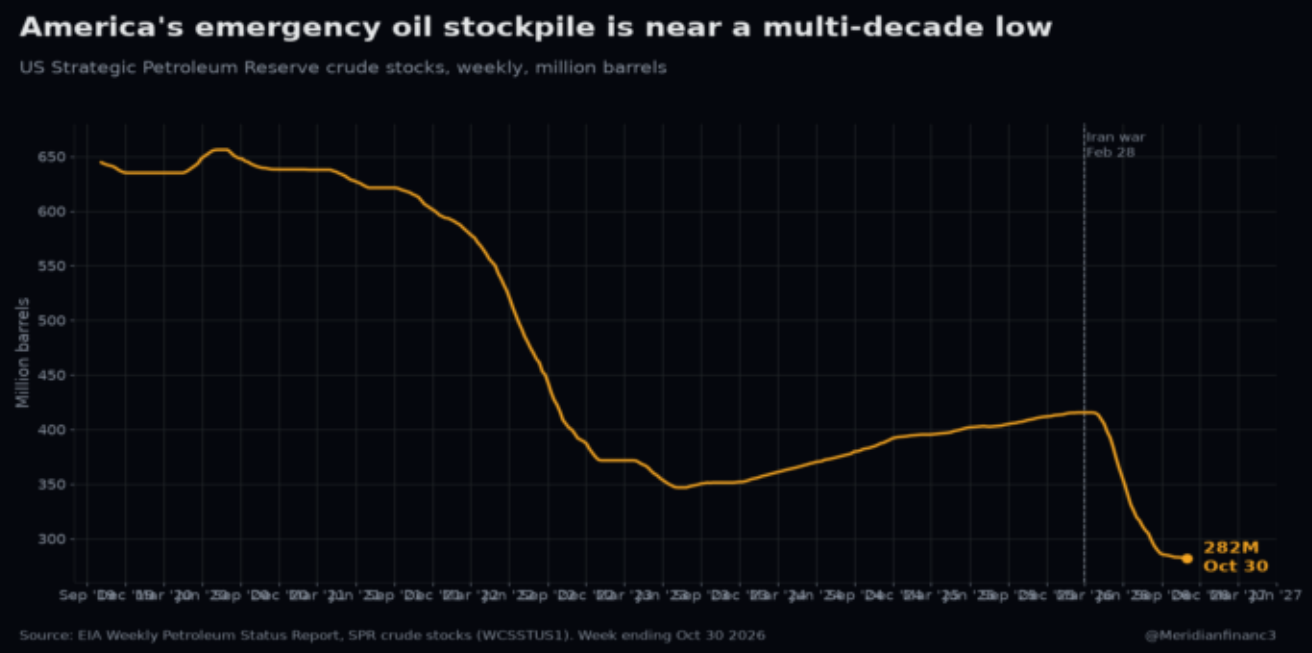
9. The jobs market cooled without breaking, so far



US unemployment is 4.2% as of September 2026 (BLS, Employment Situation release Oct 2, 2026). The labour market cooled from the post-pandemic lows without a clear break, which keeps the Fed focused on inflation rather than emergency easing.

LATEST **4.2%** BLS Employment Situation Oct 2 2026 · 2026-09-01

10. America's emergency oil stockpile is near a multi-decade low



Strategic Petroleum Reserve crude stocks are about 282M barrels as of the week ending Oct 30 (EIA Weekly Petroleum Status Report). That is far below the pre-2022 cushion, so Washington has less inventory to throw at the next Gulf shock or winter diesel squeeze.

LATEST **282M bbl** EIA · 2026-10-30

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